can’t let us eat in a room with so many flies around. It’s flipping un-healthy, man.’

Then the pool – it was a nice little pool, but it wasn’t clean. And, as I said, it was really hot. I put my foot down, saying not only could I not eat with flies all over my food, but the clinic couldn’t even bother to sort out the pool! I politely reminded them that we were people, not animals in a zoo. I was a little melodramatic, but my complaints had some effect, as within days the pool was sparkly clean and I barely saw a fly again for the rest of my stay.

The other patients were both impressed and annoyed. They said, ‘Shit, we ask for things to be done and they just ignore us. But *you* complain and they jump to it straight away.’

I became quite friendly with one of my fellow ‘guests’. He was the only guy there other than me who had his own room, so we were in the same part of the clinic. This guy was a sex addict, and for obvious reasons I won’t call him by his real name. I won’t call him Dick either. I like the guy. ‘Dave’ is a far better alias.

Dave’s addiction was so bad that every time he just thought about having sex, he shot his load. I remember one night we were watching a video and suddenly Dave bolted out of the room. I realised his hasty departure was the result of a scene in which a couple were kissing. Just *kissing*. Hectic.

He was married too. And his wife had said, ‘Listen, we can’t carry on like this. You need to sort this out.’ So that’s why Dave was in rehab. In rehab, when people are open and honest with themselves, you see them change in a matter of weeks. And when you’re going through rehab with other people, you tend to grow quite close to them. When the time then comes for a person to leave the clinic, one of the patients is asked to give a farewell speech. I gave one for Dave.

The only problem was, I got too emotional. You have to make the speech in front of everybody at the clinic, including the counsellors and both the male and female patients. I tried to tell them how much Dave had impressed me: he loved his wife, and rehab had been the only chance he’d had of saving his marriage. Dave’s situation had obviously made me think of my own life. He was doing his damndest to try to hold on to his marriage, whereas after just a year of married life, I had thrown in the towel. So, ja, I tried to give Dave a farewell speech, but I had to cut it short … I just broke down in tears.